12-Week Plan v2: Senior, Technical and AI Product Manager

7 Oct to 27 Dec 2026 (buffer 28 to 31 Dec). Weeks run Monday to Sunday. Track 1 is the focus; Principal PM is parked.

Goal by week 12

- A PM-framed CV and LinkedIn that get replies
- 6 sharp product stories
- A working, evaluated AI project (call-insights-copilot) with a PRD and architecture document in a public repo
- Enough technical fluency to hold your own with engineers
- A live pipeline of interviews for Senior, Technical or AI PM roles in CX and enterprise AI
- Track 2 (Principal or Staff TPM, forward-deployed and AI solutions roles) at about 30% of application effort

How the plan works

Build
Hands-on coding in small steps, run yourself. Synthetic or public data only.

Make
A product document: teardown, metric tree, PRD, pricing sheet.

Say
Answer out loud: mock interviews and feedback.

Reach
Outreach and applications.

Concept of the Week
About 1 hour, weeks 2 to 10. Learn one non-AI system design idea, link it to your own experience, write 5 lines in your own words.

Hours
About 20 technical hours a week (25 in weeks 6 to 8), 7 search, 12 product practice, 2 admin: 41 to 46 in total, six days, one full day off.

Sample day

- Morning: outreach and applications (2.5 h)
- Midday: technical learning (2 h)
- Afternoon: product and interview practice (1.5 to 2 h)
- Evening free: stop at a fixed time

- Sunday review (30 min): replies, screens, shaky topic, weakest interview area, top 3 actions next week. Also score the self-test green, amber or red.

Public repo: **call-insights-copilot**. Each weekly build becomes a module, and nothing from Uniphore or its customers is used.

Phases and checkpoints

Weeks 1 to 3 (7 to 25 Oct)
Screen-ready: intro pitch, three behavioral stories, product sense, metrics, AI basics, first public repo. Milestone: 25 Oct.

Weeks 4 to 5 (26 Oct to 8 Nov)
Core AI product skills: RAG, evals, first design drills. Checkpoint: 8 Nov reply-rate review.

Weeks 6 to 8 (9 to 29 Nov)
The agent arc: loop, MCP and orchestration, guardrails, observability, red-team tests, PRD. Checkpoint: 22 Nov. Fewer than 2 screens means widen titles and shift weight to Track 2.

Weeks 9 to 10 (30 Nov to 13 Dec)
Data and deployment: SQL, A/B testing, API in Docker, full mock loops. Fallback decision: 13 Dec.

Weeks 11 to 12 (14 to 27 Dec)
Polish and close: optional Kubernetes, portfolio polish, negotiation, January pipeline.

Week by week

▶ **Week 1: Foundations and first eval** (7 to 12 Oct, about 14 h) complete

▼ **Week 2: Behavioral, product sense, APIs and retrieval basics** (13 to 18 Oct, about 20 h) current

BUILD	Structured JSON output with error handling and retries; a real REST API call from Python; keyword-search mini retrieval over 5 synthetic FAQ documents, with sources cited
MAKE	Product teardown of one real product from the target list; finish the AXM story (own part: informed and consulted, not the decision-maker)
SAY	Behavioral mock 1 (intro and AXM)

REACH	8 to 10 messages, 3 to 4 applications
PORTFOLIO	README v0: problem statement and first architecture sketch
CONCEPT	APIs in depth: REST vs. webhook, status codes, API keys vs. OAuth, rate limits, idempotency

▶ **Week 3: Execution, metrics and the first agent** (19 to 25 Oct, about 20 h)

▶ **Week 4: RAG** (26 Oct to 1 Nov, about 22 h)

▶ **Week 5: Evals (Diwali week)** (2 to 8 Nov, about 22 h)

▶ **Week 6: Agents, part 1: the loop** (9 to 15 Nov, about 25 h)

▶ **Week 7: Agents, part 2: MCP and orchestration** (16 to 22 Nov, about 25 h)

▶ **Week 8: Agents, part 3: production thinking** (23 to 29 Nov, about 25 h)

▶ **Week 9: Data and experiments** (30 Nov to 6 Dec, about 18 h)

▶ **Week 10: Deployment and system design** (7 to 13 Dec, about 22 h)

▶ **Week 11: Kubernetes stretch and polish** (14 to 20 Dec, about 18 h)

▶ **Week 12: Close** (21 to 27 Dec, about 8 h)

Self-test: 25 items

Explain each to a non-engineer in 2 minutes and to an engineer in 5. Each Sunday mark green (clear, out loud), amber (partly) or red (stuck). Amber and red items go into next week's technical hours.

Core (1 to 10), all green by week 9

1. How an LLM produces an answer and why it sometimes gets it wrong
2. What RAG is and what breaks it
3. How to measure quality for an AI feature before launch
4. How an agent decides what to do and how to keep it safe
5. How real-time speech analytics works end to end

6. REST API vs. webhook, and when to use each
7. What a funnel or cohort query looks like in SQL
8. What an AI feature costs per call and how to reduce it
9. How data residency affects architecture
10. How to run an A/B test on an AI feature

System design (11 to 20), all green by week 10

11. What happens when an API call fails: retries, timeouts, idempotency
12. p50, p95, p99 latency, and why p99 matters more than the average
13. Batch vs. real-time (post-call analytics vs. live agent assist)
14. What a message queue does and what problem it solves
15. Horizontal vs. vertical scaling; when autoscaling saves or wastes money
16. What a cache is and what can go wrong with one
17. Authentication vs. authorization; protecting PII in a call transcript
18. Logs, metrics and traces; what to watch after launching an AI feature
19. Feature flags and canary releases for safe rollout and rollback
20. SQL vs. NoSQL vs. vector database: which job each fits

AI and speech (21 to 25), all green by week 12

21. Prompting vs. RAG vs. fine-tuning, with a cost example
22. Tokens and the context window; why long chats cost more
23. Small vs. large model, and routing between them to save cost
24. Word error rate and speaker separation; why mono audio hurt U-Analyze
25. Streaming vs. batch speech recognition and the effect on latency

Outreach targets and playbook

8 to 10
warm outreach a week

3 to 4
tailored applications a week (from week 2)

2 to 3
referral conversations a week (from week 3)

3+ / 8+
screens by week 6 / week 10

2+
full loops by week 10

Rules

1. Referral first: ask for a referral the same day you apply

2. Messages under 90 words: who you are, one proof point (the AXM cost story), one clear ask
3. Attach a one-page teardown with 2 or 3 ideas for their product
4. Mirror the job description in the top third of the CV, honestly
5. Show work in public: the project and two short posts
6. State availability: can start immediately
7. Be plain about the layoff: one factual sentence, then the work
8. Follow up on day 3 and day 8, short and polite
9. Apply within 48 hours of a posting, Tuesday to Thursday mornings
10. Have a 90-second 'why PM now' story

Risks to manage

- Downlevelling: most offers may be Senior PM. Decide now whether scope and pay work for you.
- Over-building: time-box the project. Small and finished beats large and unfinished.
- Technical overreach: never claim what you cannot defend. Talk about what you built, measured and what failed.
- Burnout: keep the day off and the fixed finish time.
- Slow year-end hiring: outreach and interviews are front-loaded for this reason.

Copilot modules

- Wk 1 summarizer and refund checker
- Wk 2 keyword retrieval
- Wk 3 tool-use agent and eval script
- Wk 4 RAG with embeddings
- Wk 5 eval harness
- Wk 6 agent loop with guardrails
- Wk 7 MCP server
- Wk 8 observability and red-team tests
- Wk 9 SQL analytics
- Wk 10 API in Docker
- Wk 11 Kubernetes (optional)